

# Overcoming Shame and Sexual Blocks

Reconciling with your body and your pleasure

4 psychology approaches · tips & resources · 18+ — by EvaTalk

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## BEFORE YOU BEGIN

# Reconciling with your body and your pleasure

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Body shame, inherited guilt, fear of judgment, feeling 'not normal': many carry blocks that cut them off from their pleasure and intimacy. These blocks say nothing about your worth.

This guide helps you understand where your blocks come from, reconcile with your body and pleasure, and gently uncondition yourself.

### **Your intention**

A block or shame that cuts you off from your pleasure: \_\_\_\_\_

## The 4 approaches

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This guide works your topic through 4 complementary psychology lenses. Read, do the exercises, fill the workbook — at your own pace.

**Psychodynamic** — understand the root.

**CBT** — ease the negative thoughts.

**Humanistic** — reconcile with yourself.

**Systemic** — act on your environment.

## Where your blocks come from

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Messages received (family, culture, religion), past experiences, body image: your blocks were built — they aren't a faulty 'nature' in you.

Understanding their origin is the start of freeing yourself.

### *Example*

*Raised with the idea that pleasure was 'wrong', Inès felt guilt without knowing why. Linking the shame to her history eased her.*

### **Where my shame comes from**

What messages did you internalize about the body, pleasure, the 'normal'?

### **Built, not innate**

Write: this block was learned at... (locate a possible origin).

→ *My blocks were built — they say nothing about my worth.*

## The thoughts and myths that block

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'My body isn't desirable', 'what I like is abnormal': these thoughts, often fed by unrealistic norms (comparisons, pornography), keep shame alive.

Testing them against reality loosens their grip.

### *Example*

*Sure he was 'abnormal' compared to what he saw online, Marc realized how much those images distort reality.*

### **My myths**

Note: a shameful belief · where it comes from (norm, comparison) · a more realistic version.

### **Norms vs reality**

Write one thing the 'norm' (media, porn) made you believe — that's false.

→ *Pornography and comparisons aren't reality.*

## Reconciling with your body & pleasure

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Kindness toward your body precedes pleasure. Your body doesn't have to be 'perfect' to be a source of pleasure, and your pleasure is yours — it's legitimate.

Your intimacy is yours, not others' gaze.

### *Example*

*By stopping the self-judgment and adopting gentleness toward her body, Léa gradually regained access to her sensations.*

### **Body kindness**

Write 3 kind sentences toward your body, as you would to a friend.

### **My legitimate pleasure**

Write: 'I have the right to...' (feel, explore, say what I like).

→ *Kindness toward my body opens access to pleasure.*

## Gently unconditioning yourself

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Concretely: move at your pace, rediscover your body and sensations without pressure, communicate your blocks (secrecy reinforces them), and — if blocks are deep or trauma-linked — get support.

Getting help isn't a failure: it's self-care.

### *Example*

*With a sex therapist's help, Sofia untied an old block she thought 'insurmountable'. The relief was immense.*

### **A gentle step**

What small step, at your pace, to reconnect with your sensations without pressure?

### **Talk / get help**

Whom could you talk to (partner, professional)? Does the block warrant a sex therapist?

→ *At my pace, and supported if needed, my blocks come undone.*

## Practical tips & advice

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### Tips & advice

- Your blocks often come from received messages, not a flaw in you.
- Beware unrealistic norms: pornography isn't reality.
- Move at your pace, with gentleness — kindness precedes pleasure.
- Communicate your blocks to your partner: secrecy reinforces them.
- Your pleasure and intimacy are yours — they're legitimate.
- If a block is trauma-linked or very intrusive, a sex therapist/therapist can truly help — it's not a failure.



# To fill in

## My blocks

| The block / shame | Where it comes from | A fairer version |
|-------------------|---------------------|------------------|
|                   |                     |                  |
|                   |                     |                  |
|                   |                     |                  |
|                   |                     |                  |
|                   |                     |                  |

## Kindness

| Kind sentence toward my body | A gentle step |
|------------------------------|---------------|
|                              |               |
|                              |               |
|                              |               |

## PLAN

# Your 4-week plan

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**Week 1** — Understand where my blocks come from.

**Week 2** — Test the myths against reality.

**Week 3** — Reconcile with my body.

**Week 4** — Gently uncondition myself (and get help if needed).

### Your plan in 3 lines

- The block I want to undo:
- My body-kindness sentence:
- My gentle step:

TO CLOSE

## **Your blocks can come undone — your pleasure is legitimate.**

*Your blocks can come undone — your pleasure is legitimate.*

*Adults only (18+). This guide is a psychoeducation and coaching tool — not therapy or medical advice. If your blocks are linked to trauma or cause distress, a sex therapist or therapist can support you. If you're going through a hard time, reach out to a crisis line in your country. © PerfectMatch · EvaTalk.*